

Fishbone and Five Whys cards

All three demo prompts on one card: the six-category fishbone brainstorm, the draw-the-diagram request, and the Five Whys drill that pushes a chosen cause to its root.

The prompt

Fishbone brainstorm

You are a Lean Six Sigma facilitator. I am a white belt running a root-cause brainstorm with a fishbone diagram. The effect we are trying to explain is that patients wait too long from arrival to first being seen by a physician in our emergency department. Please brainstorm possible causes, organized under the six categories, Method, Machine, Material, Manpower, Measurement, and Environment. Give me several specific, plausible causes under each, and do not hold back, I want a wide net.

Draw the diagram

Now draw this as a fishbone diagram. Put the effect on the right, the six categories as the bones, and the causes you listed along each bone, so I can copy it into my project file. Ask the chat tool to draw it, do not send it to an AI image generator, because image generators paint pictures and garble the labels.

Five Whys

Let us do a Five Whys on the cause that admitted patients board in the ED. Ask me why five times to push toward a root cause.

What good output looks like

Prompt 1 returns a fully organized fishbone in text with several plausible causes under each of the six categories (for example, under Method: no standard triage sequence, registration before bed assignment; under Manpower: too few triage nurses at peak, physician coverage that does not match arrival patterns; under Environment: predictable evening surges and boarding of admitted patients). Prompt 2 renders the actual picture with the effect on the right and labelled bones. Prompt 3 runs the Five Whys chain: admitted patients board, no inpatient bed is ready, bed assignment upstairs is slow, no one clearly owns the handoff the moment a patient is admitted. The root cause is an unowned handoff, not lazy nurses. The machine brainstorms, the human verifies and prunes.